

Tianhui Wu

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Education

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Iowa	Expected May 2027
<i>Dissertation:</i> “Understanding the Role of Propaganda in Shaping Corruption Perceptions in Autocracies”	
<i>Committee:</i> Frederick Solt (Chair), Elise Pizzi, Marina Zalzovaya, and Qihang Lin	
M.A. in Political Science, University of Iowa	2024
M.A. in Political Theory, Sun Yat-sen University	2022
B.A. in Political Science and Public Administration, Fudan University	2019

Research Interests

Substantive: Comparative politics; authoritarian politics; political communication; corruption and governance; comparative public opinion and political behavior; China and East Asia.

Methods: Text-as-data; causal inference with observational panel data; cross-national time-series survey analysis.

Publications ** indicates corresponding author*

- Boehmke, Frederick J., Thomas Dainty, Samantha J. DeRagon, Hyein Ko, Taylor Tokos, **Tianhui Wu***, and Weidong Zhang. Forthcoming. “The Use of Visualization in Political Science: A Century of Growth and the Current State.” *PS: Political Science and Politics*.
- Xia, Ying, and **Tianhui Wu**. 2024. “[Building Consensus: Implementing the ‘One-Shoulder’ Policy in a Village with a Divided Elite Structure](#).” *Journal of Sun Yat-sen University (Social Science Edition)* 64(4): 155–164. (In Chinese)
- Xia, Ying, Tianqing Chen, and **Tianhui Wu**. 2023. “[Public Petition and Government Responsiveness: Evidence from City A](#).” *Fudan Public Administration Review* 27(2): 101–116. (In Chinese)

Manuscripts Under Review ** indicates corresponding author*

- Wu, Tianhui**. “How the Public Perceives Hidden Corruption: Opinion Leadership and Elite Cues.”
- Hu, Yue, **Tianhui Wu***, and Wenfang Tang. “The Political Impacts of Grassroots Corruption in China and Their Mechanisms.” (in Chinese)
- Wu, Tianhui**, Elise Pizzi, and Tracy Osborn. “Focus on Disaster: Why Attention to Hazards Appears in Party Manifestos.”
- Pizzi, Elise, **Tianhui Wu***, and Sara McLaughlin Mitchell. “Reducing Post-Disaster Conflict Risk Through Migrant Remittances.”

Working Papers

- Wu, Tianhui**. “Measuring Anti-Corruption Propaganda in China’s Official Media: A Text-Based Analysis of News Broadcasts.”
- Wu, Tianhui**. “When Corruption Comes Home: Own-Province Investigation Reporting and Public Perceptions in China.”
- Wu, Tianhui**. “Do Elections Reduce or Reinforce Perceived Corruption? Comparative Evidence from Democracies.”
- Wu, Tianhui**. “Protest the Suppression of Protest: A Study of Emotional Mechanisms behind the 2019–2020 Hong Kong Protests.”
- Wu, Tianhui**, and Caroline J. Tolbert. “State Electoral Competition, Winners and Losers, and Perceived Electoral Integrity.”

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Iowa

Introduction to Comparative Politics (online) Fall 2022, Fall 2026

Designed the weekly structure, wrote all prompts and assessments, and graded all written work. Co-developed two discussion boards in which students tracked political developments in an assigned country or topic.

Local Politics (online) Fall 2022

Sole instructor for an asynchronous course on local government structure, elections, intergovernmental relations, and urban service provision. Supervised civic-engagement assignments and carried out all grading and feedback.

Teaching Assistant, University of Iowa

Introduction to Political Analysis Spring 2023, Spring 2024

Led four discussion sections of approximately 20 students each, covering game theory, sampling and margin of error, and network analysis. Graded weekly problem sets and held review sessions before exams.

Big Ideas: Introduction to Information, Society, and Culture Fall 2023

Guided in-class work on data quality, sampling bias, network, geospatial, and time-series visualizations, providing on-the-spot instruction and guidance to student teams. Graded all homework and examinations.

Graduate Instruction and Methods Workshops

Stata Workshop, Graduate Advanced Methods Seminar, University of Iowa Sept 2025

Designed and taught a full empirical workflow, from data import and cleaning through model specification and interpretation, for graduate students with limited quantitative background.

Methods Workshop: Using Large Language Models with Python, University of Iowa Sept 2024

Co-taught with Eric Ngo. Led hands-on applications in Python, using Hugging Face pipelines and the OpenAI API to classify corruption-related sentences drawn from party platform data.

Teaching Interests

Undergraduate: Introduction to Comparative Politics; Authoritarian Politics; Chinese Politics; Political Research Methods; Corruption and Governance.

Doctoral: Comparative Political Behavior and Public Opinion; Computational Text Analysis; Corruption and Governance; Chinese and East Asian Politics.

Research Experience

Disasters, Migration, and Violence (DMV) Lab, NSF-funded | Research Assistant 2024–2025

- Worked with Professors Sara Mitchell and Elise Pizzi.
- Built a new cross-national time-series dataset on government responses to disasters.
- Co-authored papers and contributed to empirical analysis, writing, and conference presentations.

Genetically Modified Organisms (GMO) Research | Research Assistant Summer 2023, 2024

- Worked with Professor David Greenwood-Sanchez.
- Collected Chinese official policy documents on potato promotion.
- Conducted data analysis and visualization of public attitudes toward GMOs in Mexico.

Additional Training

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, University of Rochester Summer 2024

Generative AI, large language models, machine learning, text analysis, and data visualization.

Best Paper Award: “Party Ideology, Corruption Scandal, and Corruption Framing: Evidence from Party Manifestos in Latin America.”

Conference Presentations

- “Persuasion or Reminder? Provincial Anti-Corruption Reporting and Corruption Perceptions in China.” Midwest Association for Public Opinion Research (MAPOR) Conference, Chicago, Nov 2026.
- “Measuring Anti-Corruption Propaganda in China’s Official Media: A Text-Based Analysis of News Broadcasts.” APSA Political Communication Preconference, Boston, Sept 2026.
- “Propaganda and Corruption Perceptions in Autocracies: Evidence from China.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2026.
- “Anti-Corruption as Propaganda: Evidence from China’s Official News Broadcasts.” Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Conference, New Orleans, Jan 2026.
- “From Public and Elite Opinion to Petty and Grand Corruption.” American Political Science Association (APSA) Conference, Vancouver, Canada, Sept 2025.
- “How Does Public Opinion Influence Government Corruption? A Cross-National Study.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2025.
- “The State of Data Visualization in Political Science.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2025.
- “Framing Democracy in Political Party Manifestos.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2025.
- “The Emotional Mechanisms behind the 2019–2020 Hong Kong Protests.” American Political Science Association (APSA) Conference, Philadelphia, Sept 2024.
- “Perceived Corruption and Ethnic over National Identification in Africa.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2024.
- “How Do Elections Affect Perceived Corruption: Cross-National Empirical Evidence.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2024.
- “Protest the Suppression of Protest: A Study of the 2019–2020 Hong Kong Protests.” Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Conference, Chicago, April 2024.
- “The Motivation of Informed Voters: How Partisanship Influences the Acquisition of Political Information.” American Political Science Association (APSA) Conference, Los Angeles, Sept. 2023.

Awards and Honors

- Best Paper Award, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, University of Rochester, 2024.
- Graduate College Post-Comprehensive Research Fellowship (\$11,375), University of Iowa, 2025.
- Graduate College Summer Fellowship (\$5,500), University of Iowa, 2026.
- Best Graduate Seminar Paper, Department of Political Science, University of Iowa, 2025.
- Departmental Summer Scholarship (\$2,000; \$5,500), University of Iowa, 2023, 2025.
- Prestage-Cook Travel Award (\$500), SPSA Conference, 2026.
- Graduate Student Senate (GSS) Travel Funds (\$320, \$300), University of Iowa, 2025-2026.
- Travel Grant (\$500, \$1,500, \$1,350), Department of Political Science, University of Iowa, 2024-2026.
- Travel Grant Award (\$500), APSA Conference’s Democracy & Autocracy Section, 2025.
- Graduate & Professional Student Government (GPSG) Travel Grant (\$350), University of Iowa, 2024.
- National Scholarship for Graduate Students (\$2,850), Ministry of Education of China, 2021.
- First Class Grant and Scholarship, Graduate School (\$8,570), Sun Yat-sen University, 2019–2021.
- First Prize of the 16th “Challenge Cup” National College Students’ Extracurricular Academic and Technological Works Competition, hosted by the China Academy of Sciences, Ministry of Education of China, the National Association of Students, etc., 2019.
- Excellent Undergraduate, Fudan University, 2019.
- First Prize of 2018 “Knowledge and Action Cup” Shanghai College Students’ Social Practice Project Competition, hosted by Shanghai Municipal Education Commission, Shanghai Student Union, etc., 2018.

Service

Peer Reviewer: *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*.

Invited Talk: “Corruption Perception and the Fight Against Corruption.” School of Government, Sun Yat-sen University, Nov 2024.

Skills

Languages: Mandarin Chinese and English. Research, teaching, and publication in both.

Software: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, Git/GitHub, Gephi.

Methods: Text-as-data and word-embedding measurement, multilevel models, time-series and panel analysis, causal inference, spatial statistics, survival analysis.

References

Frederick Solt

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Sara McLaughlin Mitchell

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